

The Comfort Crisis .

Five rules · twenty-one chapters · one expedition into the Arctic

I MAKE IT REALLY HARD

Rule One & Two — and Don't Die

01 33 Days

The Arctic tarmac, and the case against comfort

02 35, 55 or 75

Sobriety reveals comfort everywhere

03 0.004%

Our wiring is older than our world

04 800 Faces

Problem creep and comfort creep

05 20 Yards

Donnie, and the first taste of the wild

06 50 / 50

Misogi: hard enough to maybe fail

07 50, 70 or 90

Rewilding the body and mind

08 150 People

Cities run against our wiring

09 101 Miles

Alone, and the gift of solitude

10 70+ MPH

The storm makes everything vivid

II REDISCOVER BOREDOM

Ideally Outside, for Minutes, Hours, and Days

11 11 Hrs, 6 Min

Boredom is a signal, not an enemy

12 20 Min · 5 Hrs · 3 Days

The nature pyramid

13 12 Places

Silence resets the brain

III FEEL HUNGER

Lean Times Are a Feature, Not a Flaw

14 -4,000 Calories

Real hunger vs. reward hunger

15 12-16 Hours

Lean times repair the body

IV THINK ABOUT YOUR DEATH EVERY DAY

Picture the Cliff So You Can Change Course

16 3 Good Legs

Fair chase, and stepping into the cycle

17 Dec 31, 11:59:33

Picture the cliff ahead

18 20 Min, 11 Sec

The kill, and a monk's last hike

V CARRY THE LOAD

The Act That Made Us Human

19 100+ Pounds

Your brain quits before your body

20 ≤ 50 Pounds

Born to carry — so ruck

21 80%

Escape the diseases of captivity

EP 81.2 Years

Harder to kill, and more alive

“Constant comfort is a radically new thing for us humans.”

— MICHAEL EASTER

Notice · Embrace · Carry

Three phases for turning the science of discomfort into a practice

NOTICE

See the comfort creep

- **Audit your 72° life**
Where do you feel any discomfort at all?
- **Name your comfort blanket**
The thing you numb stress with.
- **Catch the goalpost moving**
A new convenience becoming a “need.”
- **Reframe your problems**
Most stress is first-world stress.
- **Track one honest number**
Food or screen time — no judgment.
- **Find your 2%**
Stairs over escalator; walk over drive.

EMBRACE

Run your own misogi

- **Pick a misogi**
Hard, ~50/50, and you won't die.
- **Ruck**
30–50 lbs in a pack — just walk.
- **Rediscover boredom**
Don't reach for the phone.
- **Bank nature doses**
20 min, 3× a week, phone away.
- **Feel real hunger**
Go 12–16 hours; you are safe.
- **Seek silence & solitude**
Devices off; real time alone.
- **Train cold**
Drop the thermostat a few degrees.

CARRY

Make it a way of life

- **Memento mori**
Think of death; picture the cliff.
- **Eat like an adult**
Whole foods mostly; nothing banned.
- **Move like a generalist**
Squat, hinge, carry, hang.
- **Carry the load for others**
Build your well of fortitude.
- **Get a little dirty**
Outside, fiber, less sanitizer.
- **Fill your scrapbook**
Keep doing novel hard things.
- **Plan the next misogi**
Comfort creep always returns.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Comfort creep is invisible and constant, so there is no finish line.

The cure isn't one heroic feat — it's a steady diet of chosen discomfort.

Get comfortable being uncomfortable — and become harder to kill, and more alive.